



Case Studies Presentation

November 2025

Hi! It's nice to meet you.

Thanks for checking out my case study presentation.



Mason Kelly

Senior UX Researcher



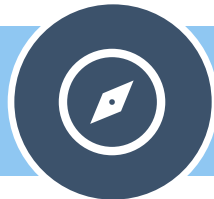
Graduated from James Madison University with a BA in Sociology & from
the University of Virginia with an MS in Business Analytics.
Lead a team of 4 UX Researchers on enterprise product IFM Hub for CBRE.

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Case Study #3



Utilizing Deep User Knowledge: Identifying Where AI Agents Can Provide the Most
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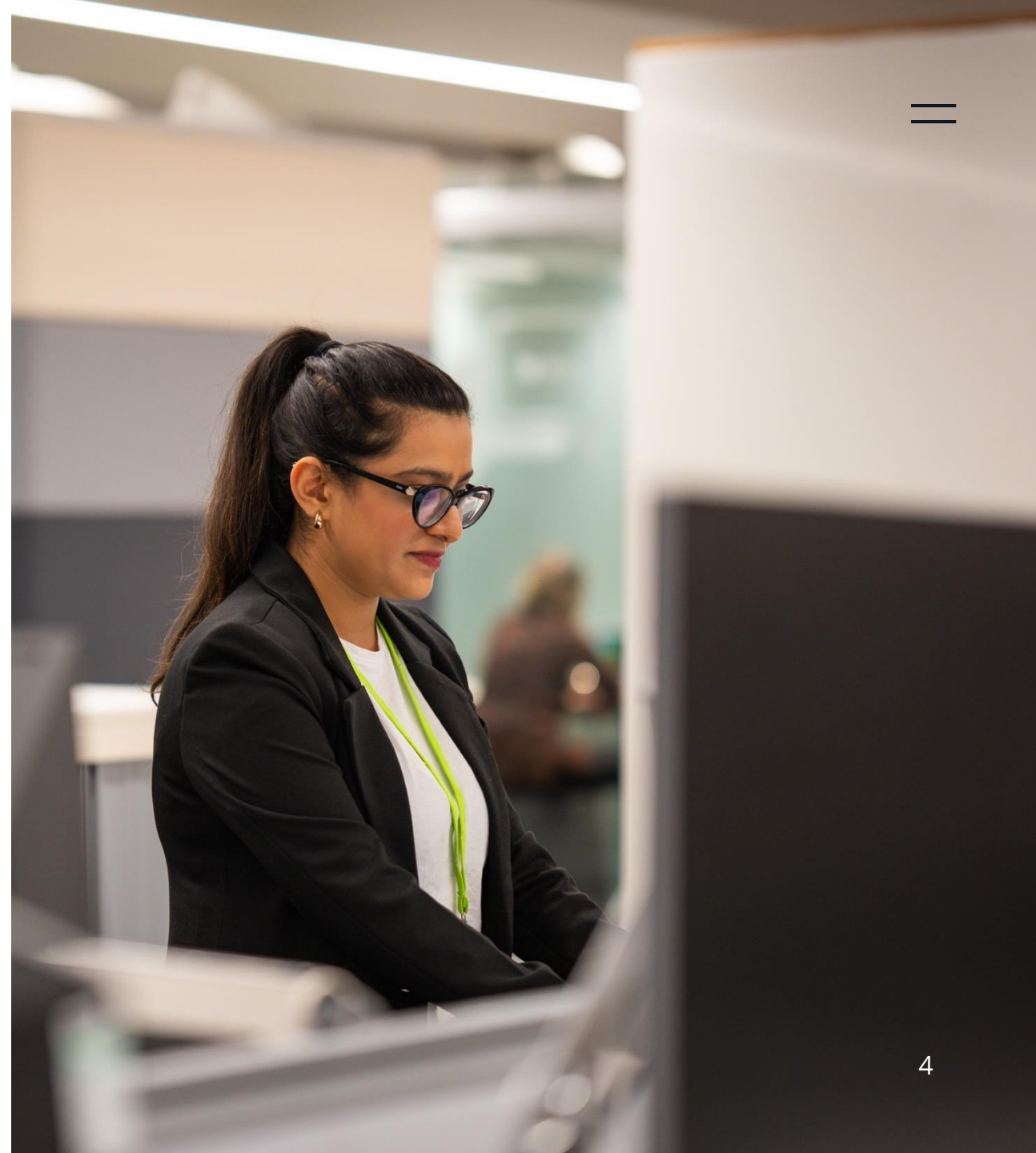
Q&A

What is CBRE?

CBRE is the world's largest commercial real estate company. CBRE leases & sells commercial real estate and provides facility management services to its clients which include 90% of Fortune 500 companies.

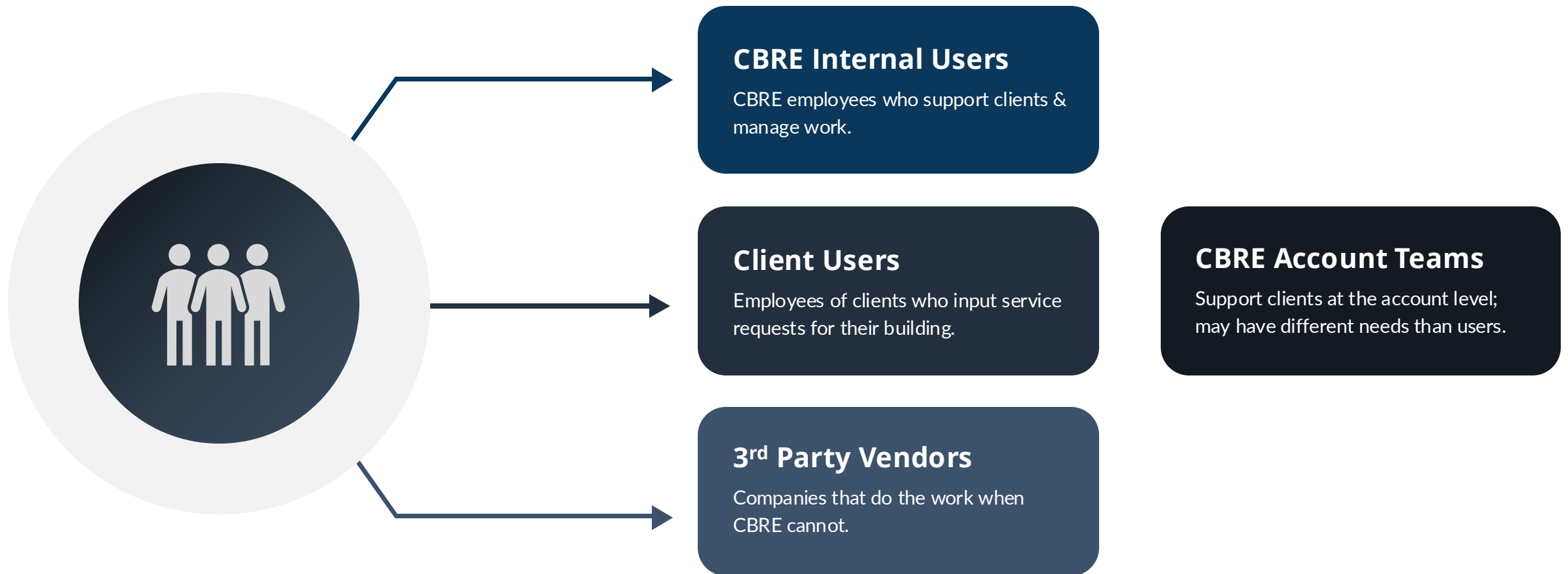
What is IFM Hub?

IFM Hub is a CMMS platform. It is an internally built platform that serves as the primary way CBRE manages the facility management work it provides for its clients.



Relevant Customers

End Users & Key Stakeholders





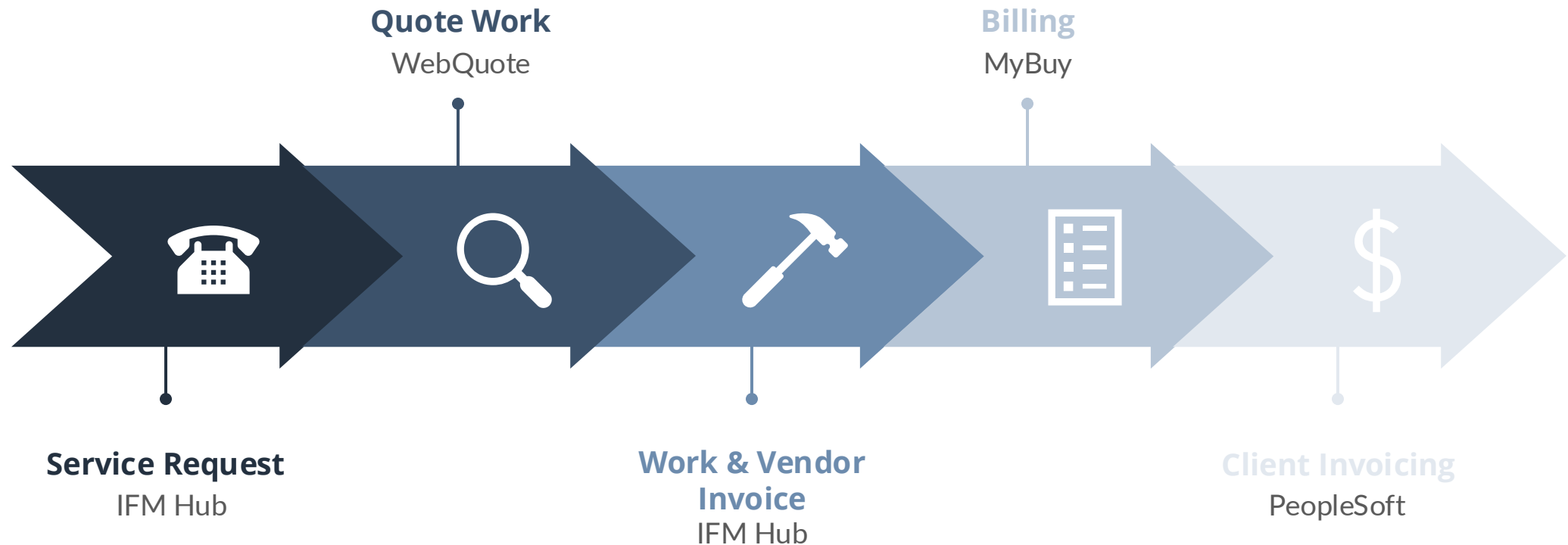
Guiding Product Strategy:

Driving New Domain Development
Through Exploratory & Evaluative User
Research

Case Study #1

The Work Order Process

& What Platform Each Stage Lives On



The Business Problem



Lack of integrated, internal finance capabilities was leading to accounts refusing to transition to the platform and causing unnecessary spend.



Account Transition Blocker

Pre-transition accounts have called out that an unintegrated finance process is a blocker for transition to the new platform. Users have complained that they are spending too much time bouncing back & forth between products.



Reliance on Third-Party Products

The reliance on third-party finance products increases spend long-term and reduces control CBRE has to meet its clients' unique needs.

Goals & My Role

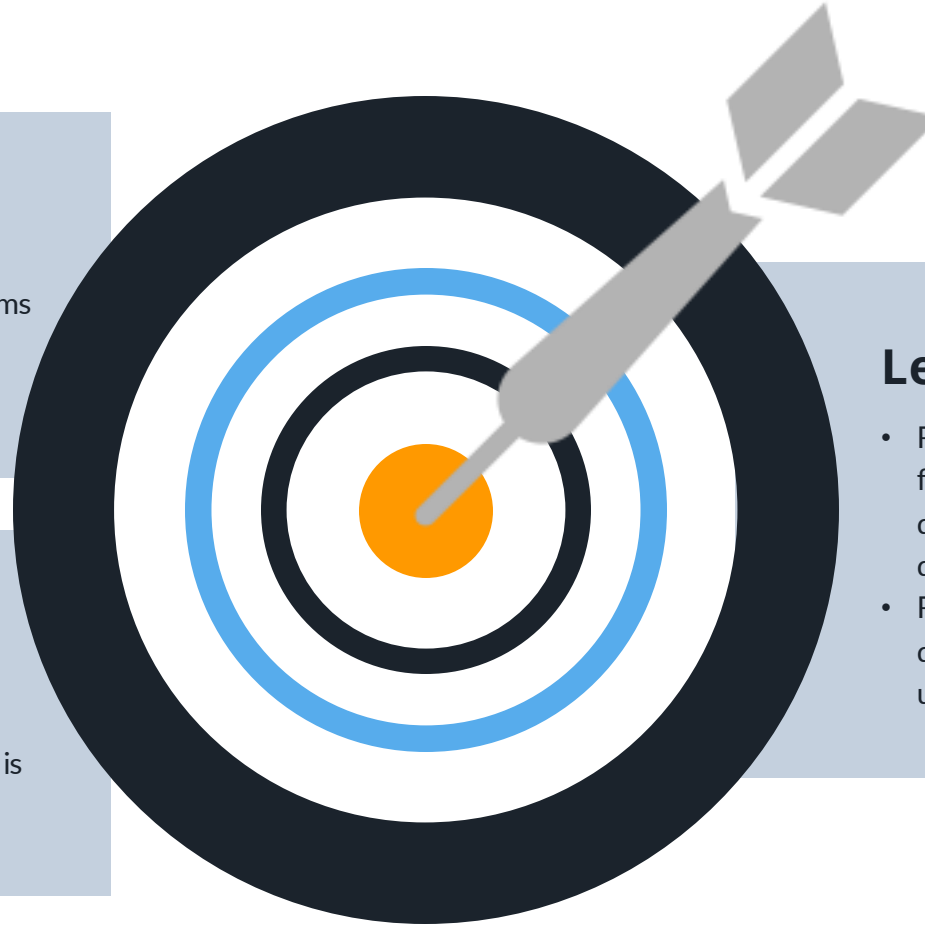


As a team...

- Build a more centralized finance process within IFM Hub & ensure that account teams are satisfied (as measured by account transitions).

As a researcher...

- Ensure that inefficient & duplicative processes are minimized so that users are more satisfied (measured by UEM) & work is being completed more efficiently.

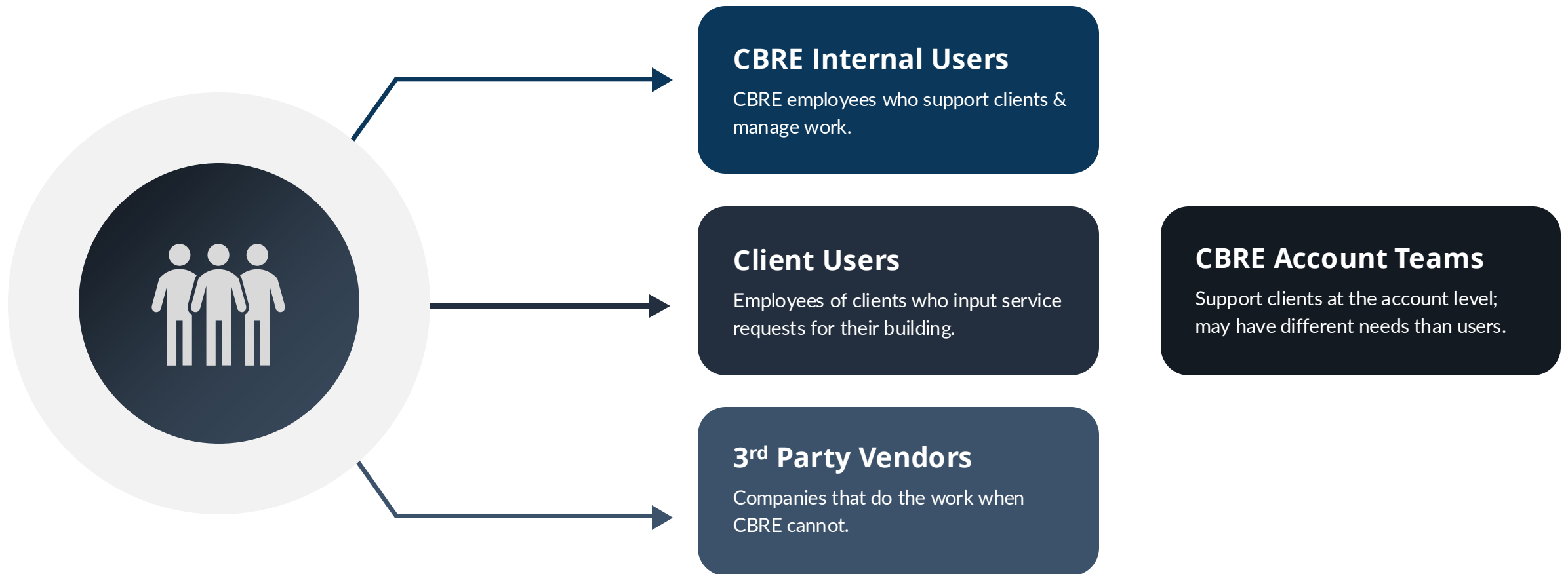


Lead UX Researcher

- Responsible for discovery research into new finance domains to identify user needs & define user stories for capability development.
- Responsible for evaluative research of designs developed for new domains to ensure user needs are met and flows are usable.

Relevant Customers

End Users & Key Stakeholders



Case Study #1

Project Considerations



Timeline

- Development starts in Q1
- Release is slated for Q3



Scale

- 3 new domains
- 100+ accounts
- 20,000+ users



UXR Scope

- Internal & External Discovery
- Evaluation Post-Design Phase



Team

- Lead UX Researcher
- Principal UX Designer
- Principal Product Manager
- 5 Product Managers
- Business Partners

Research Questions

Determined at kickoff meeting & socialized in research plan

01



Discovery

1. What do users need to be able to do across processes?
2. How have other CMMS platforms implemented a centralized finance process?
3. What does our current internal process look like and where are the pain points?
4. How might we capitalize on the strong points of other platforms while improving on the pain points?



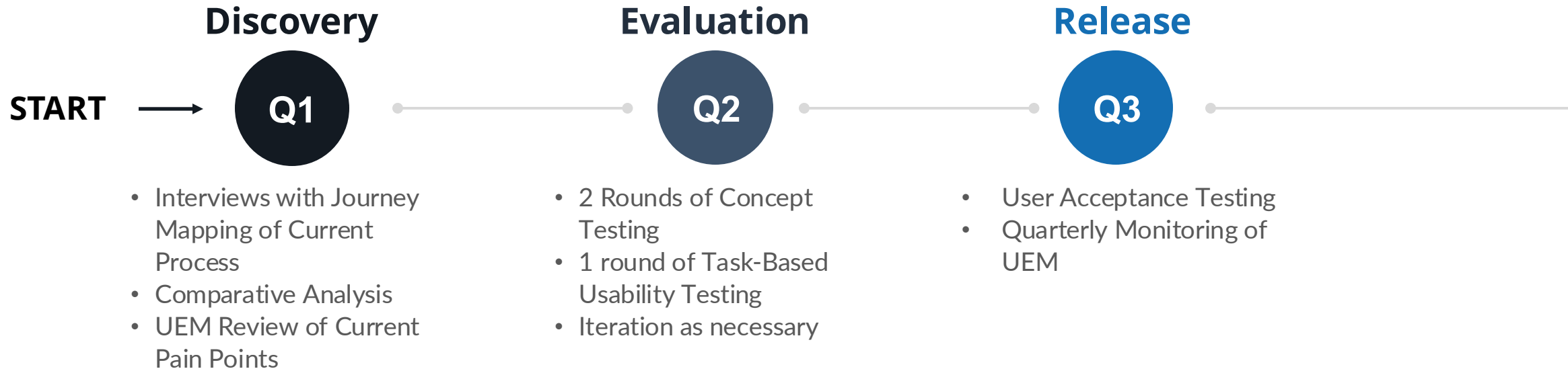
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Evaluation

1. Do the planned capabilities fulfil user needs?
2. Do the users have the info they need to act effectively?
3. Are the primary user flows efficient & intuitive?

Research Activities

The project team had 2 quarters to build new domains.

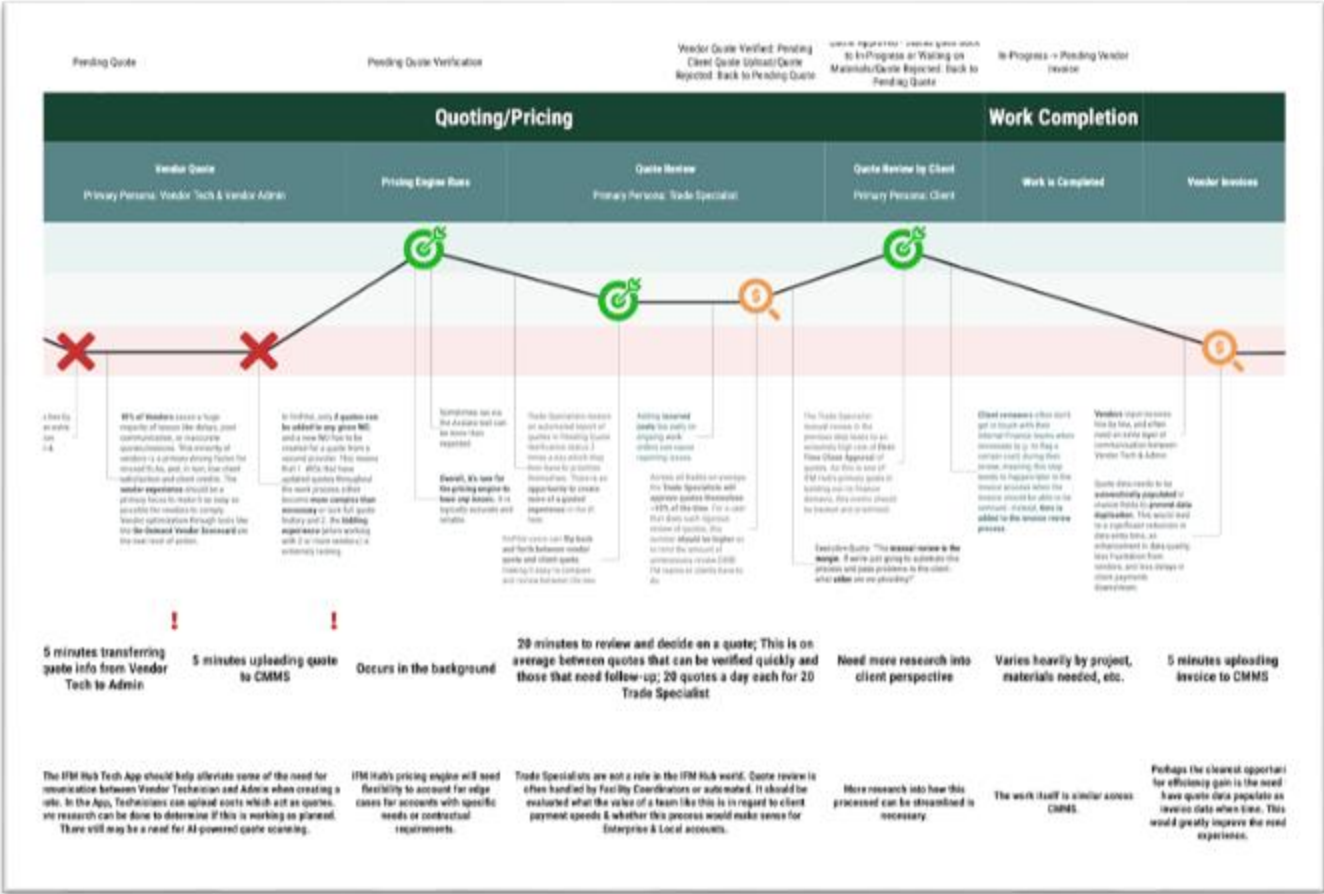


Key Discovery Insight

Delivered via Journey Map & Slide Deck

Journey Mapping & UEM Review

- In current state, only 2 quotes can be added to any given WO, and a new WO must be created for a quote from a second provider. This makes comparing and approving quotes much more challenging.
- (resulting Jira ticket: SR-49658)



Key Evaluation Insights

Delivered via Slide Deck

Concept Testing

- Overall, feedback across flows was positive. Users did call out **several data points that they typically use to filter** by that were not included in the prototype: priority, site, asset name.
 - (resulting Jira ticket: SR-45532)

Usability Testing

- The only task that was failed by a majority of users in usability testing was **comparing quotes**. This was due to the "compare" button not being intuitive to users. Replacing the compare button in the UI with something more intuitive would alleviate this issue.
 - (resulting Jira ticket: SR-53251)

Flow 1: Vendor Quote	
Task 1: Access a newly assigned quote in draft status.	Success
Task 2: Add one hour of plumbing labor to the quote.	Success
Task 3: Edit the scope of work.	Success
Task 4: Use the quote assistant to add a material cost.	Success
Task 5: Submit the quote.	Success
Flow 2: CBRE Quote Approval	
Task 1: Review submitted quotes for an activity.	Success
Task 2: View cost summary for Quote #1.	Success
Task 3: Compare provider Quotes #1 & #2.	Failure
Task 4: Add a plumbing labor cost for Quote #2.	Success
Task 5: Submit Quote #2 & fix any issues associated with the submission.	Success
Task 6: Download the quote.	Success

Impact

4

Accounts

Removed Transition Blocker

These accounts now feel comfortable transitioning to IFM Hub, progressing towards high-level goal of transitioning all SI7 accounts.

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Insights

Actioned by Product

From discovery through evaluation, UX research had a quantifiable impact on the product roadmap and release state of the new domains.



6.1
Point

Increase in UEM

From Q2 to Q3, there was a 6.1-point jump in Total UEM. Part of the cause of this jump may be due to improved integration & finance flow experience.

Key Challenges

& Reflection on What I Would Do Differently Given the Chance



No Budget for Scaled Usability Testing

This resulted in the inability to capture enough time on task data to be confident in declaring that we saw a significant improvement had we done 2 rounds of usability testing.



Design Being Built During Testing

This resulted in the need to work iteratively and take extra care to track what concepts what users had seen during concept testing.



Complex Processes

I had not worked on finance-related products before this work, so I needed to quickly get up to speed on complex topics so I could properly empathize and communicate with end users.



Questions?





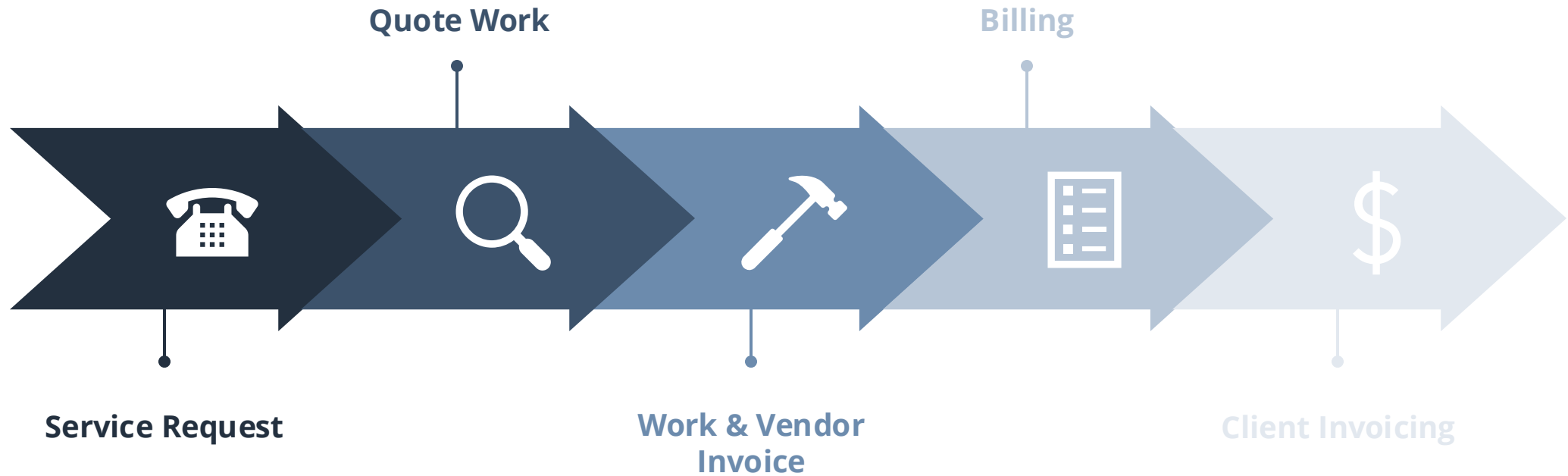
Creating a **Feedback Loop:**

The Cycle of Measuring & Improving
Usability in Enterprise Products

Case Study #2

The Work Order Process

=



The Business Problem



By the end of 2024, 50% of service requests were being input via calls to CBRE call centers. Such a high rate of call center calls was resulting in call center employees spending less time on emergency or highly complex requests, instead spending much of their time on straightforward requests that should be able to be input via self-service.

50%

of Service Requests were
being input via calls to CBRE
call centers.

Goals & My Role

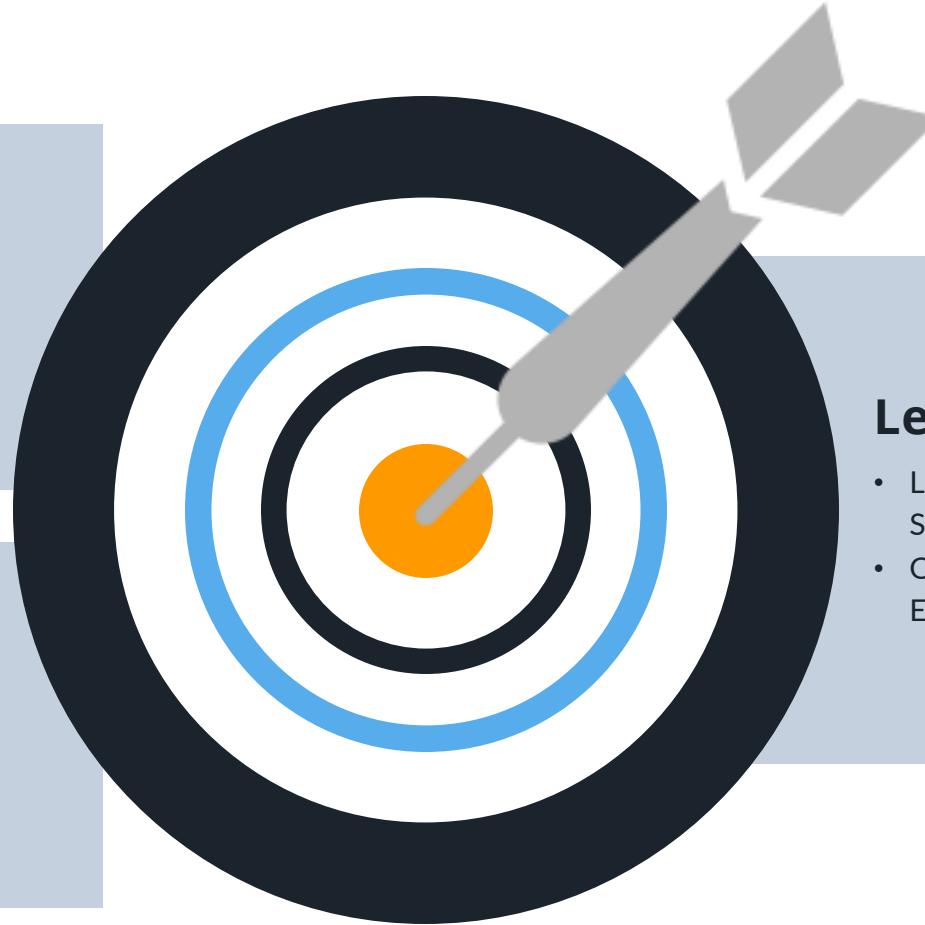


As a team...

- Make improvements to the Self-Service Request flow so that calls to the Call Center go down (as measured by call center rate).

As a researcher...

- Identify if there is an underlying issue causing users to use the Self-Service Request less than expected.
- Determine what design improvements can be made to increase usability scores & usage of Self-Service flow.

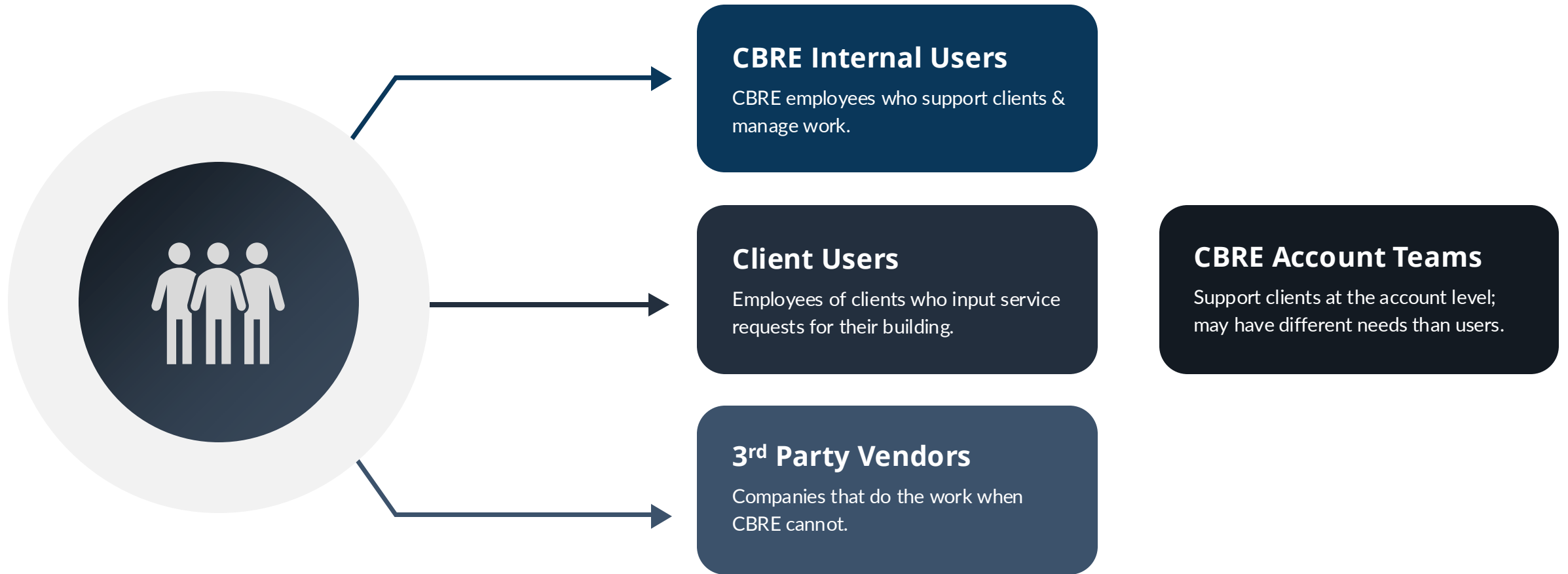


Lead UX Researcher

- Lead research for IFM Hub, including the Self-Service domain.
- Owner of the IFM Hub quarterly User Experience Metric.

Relevant Customers

End Users & Key Stakeholders



Case Study #2

Project Considerations



Timeline

- Business Problem identified mid-Q1
- Need for implementation of improvements by end of Q1



Scale

- 20,000 requests a month
- 100+ accounts
- 10,000+ users



UXR Scope

- Qualitative analysis of UEM comments
- Further investigation of identified problem flows



Team

- Lead UX Researcher
- UX Designer
- Product Manager
- Business Partners

Baseline Metrics

50%

CC Rate

Of Total Requests

20,000 requests a month.

64.7

UEM Score

**For Self-Service
Module in Q1**

70 is the score determined to be
“good” by the UEM.

N/A

Time on
Task

No Product Analytics

No Product Analytics available in
Q1 2025.

Research Questions

Determined at kickoff meeting & socialized in research plan

01



Qualitative Analysis of UEM Comments

1. What themes or pain points are surfacing in the UEM comments?
2. For each theme or pain point, how many users are mentioning it compared to other themes or pain points?



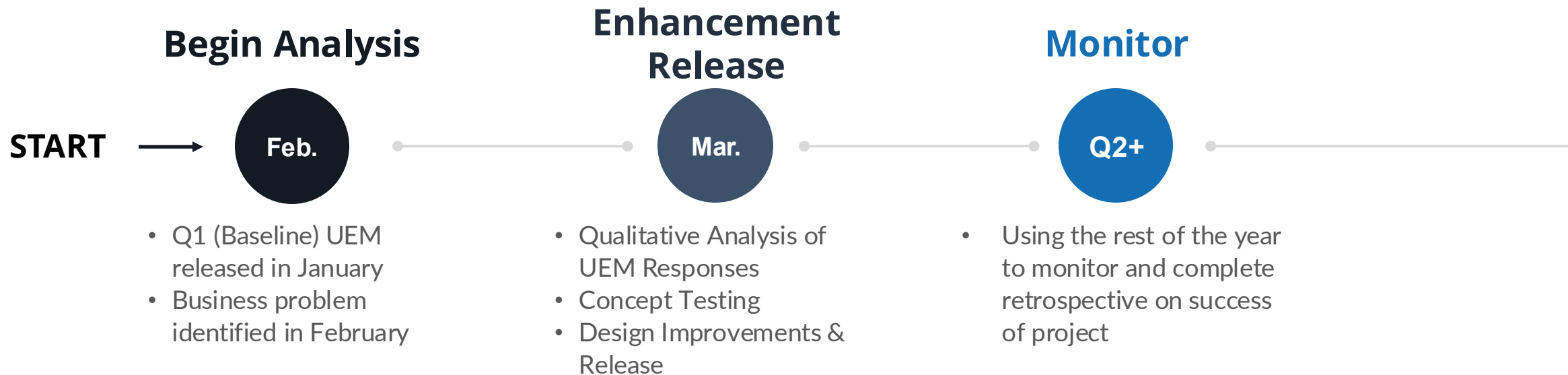
02

Testing of Problematic Flow

1. What information do they need to efficiently input a service request?
2. What is preventing them from accomplishing this?
3. What is causing them to drop-off?

Research Activities

The project team half a quarter to identify impactful issues in Self-Service flow.



Key Finding

Uncovered In UEM Qualitative Analysis & Confirmed in Concept Testing

The location selector within the request flow was unforgiving when attempting to input locations.

1. Many users weren't saving their default location.
2. When trying to change the room or area for a location, users couldn't click back to the previous hierarchy step but, rather, **had to retype the entire location**.
3. Search results for a location were showing each of these levels when most users were always at just one building **obfuscating key information**.

Insights led to a Jira ticket for design improvements (SR-46530) and the design improvements were picked up by dev and released by the end of Q1.

Create Service Request ✕

Requestor Name

Mason Kelly

Location

Select location... ▾

Country > Region > State > Building > Floor > Area

📍 Reception Area

📍 Conference Room

Data Field

Facilities ▾

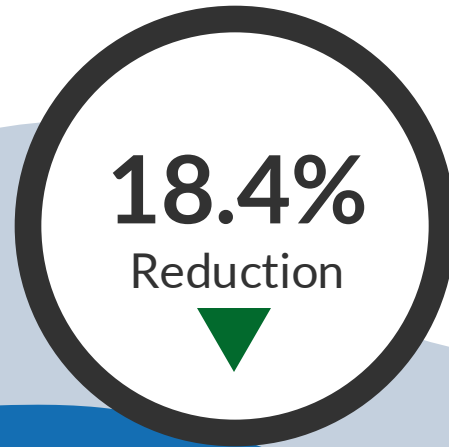
Data Field

Enter asset ID or description

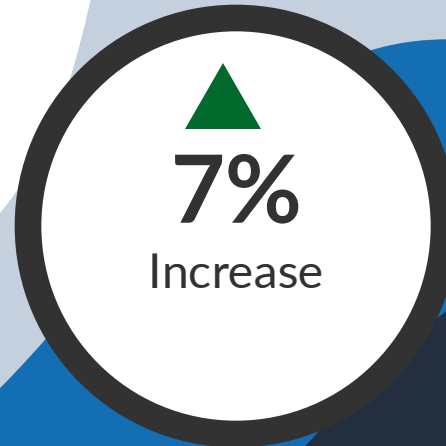
Cancel Submit Request

*Personal design created in UX Pilot

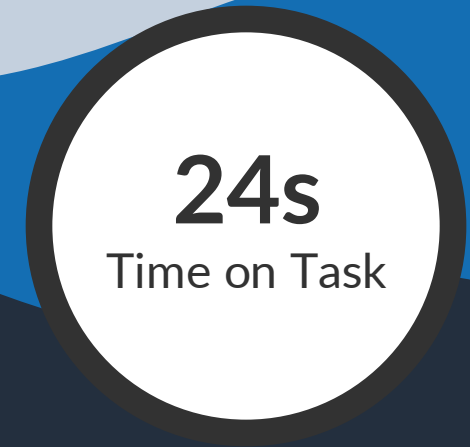
Impact



**In Call Center
Request Rate**



In Total UEM Score
For the Self-Service module.



**To Select a
Location**

Key Challenges



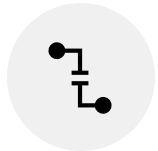
Lack of Product Analytics

Our product analytics capabilities matured throughout the year but were spotty before Q3 as events were being set up.



Quick Turnaround

A tight timeline limited research's ability to do more rigorous testing than concept testing.



Inability to Prove Causality

While we do see metrics like call center rate and UEM score improve, I did not A/B test these designs, so I have no way of truly identifying that these design improvements directly caused the improvements in metrics.



Questions?





Utilizing Deep User Knowledge:

Identifying Where AI Agents Can Provide
the Most Value

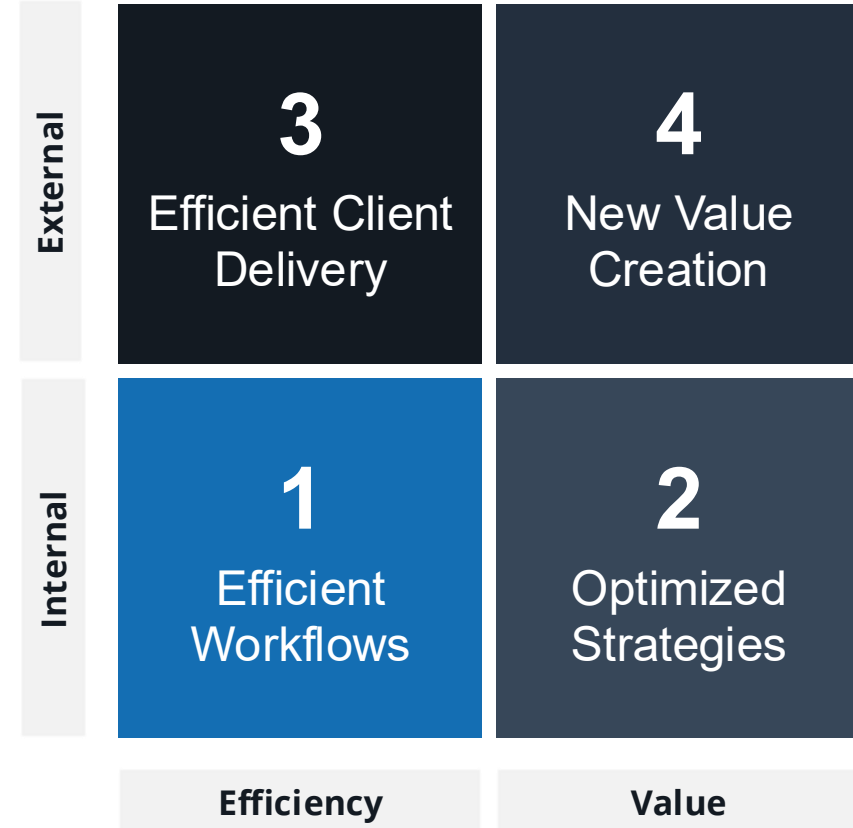
Case Study #3

Classifying AI Investments

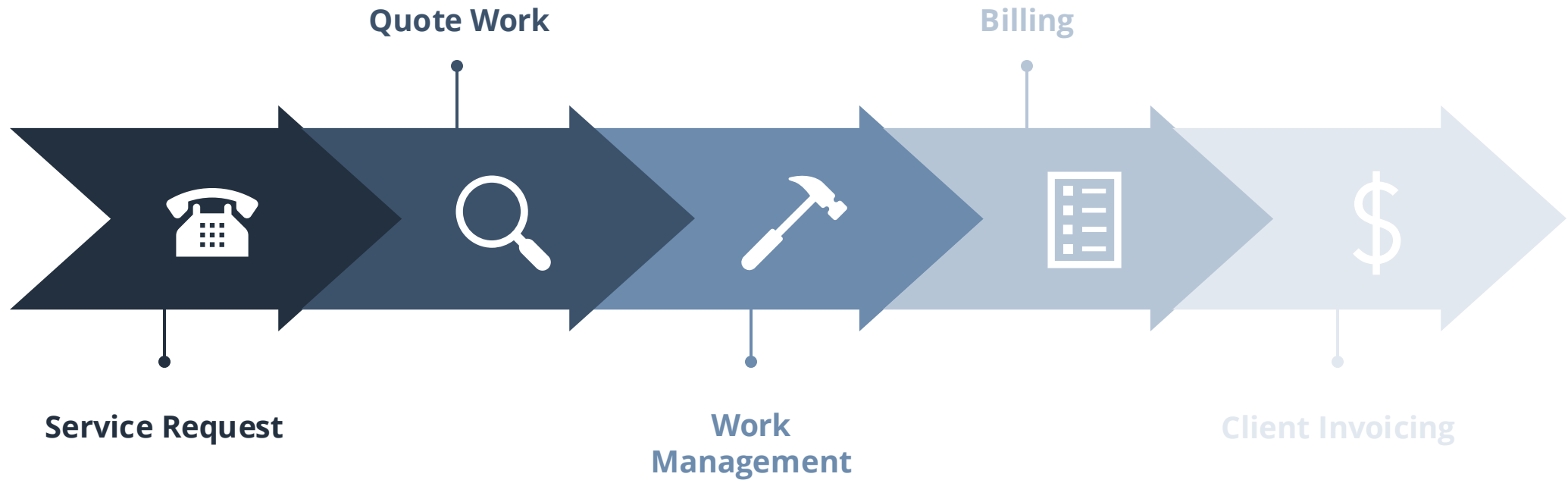
& Framing How AI/ML Creates Value for the Organization

4 Quadrants

- **1. Efficient Workflows:** Using AI/ML to enhance internal operational flows.
- **2. Optimized Strategies:** Using AI/ML or advanced analytics to enhance internal decision-making.
- **3. Efficient Client Delivery:** Using AI/ML to improve end user/client efficiency.
- **4. New Value Creation:** Using AI/ML to foundationally shift how the organization provides value to clients.



The Work Order Process



The Business Problem



CBRE employees were spending up to 40% of their time actively managing work orders.

40%

of time spent by FMs
actively managing ongoing
work.

Goals & My Role

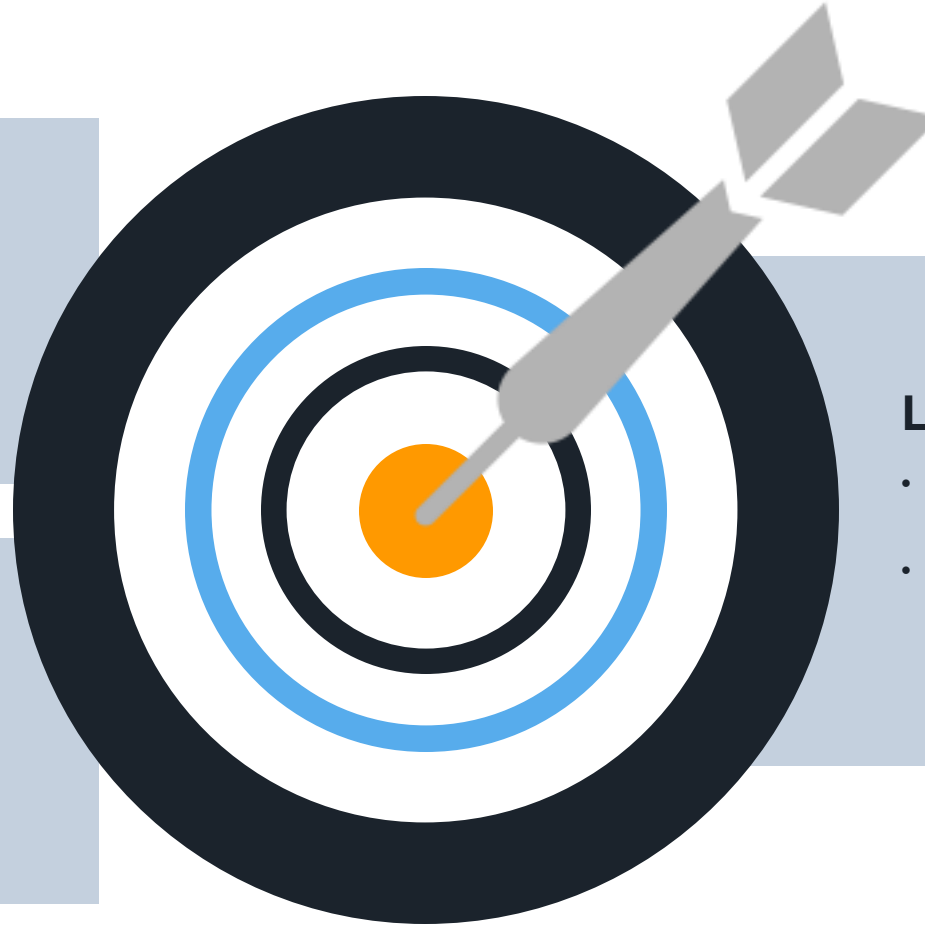


As a team...

- Build AI agents to increase efficiency (as measured by time on task) of internal workers + outcomes for clients (as measured by work order time).

As a researcher...

- Identify the ripest opportunities for automation within the work order flow to increase usability (as measured by UEM).

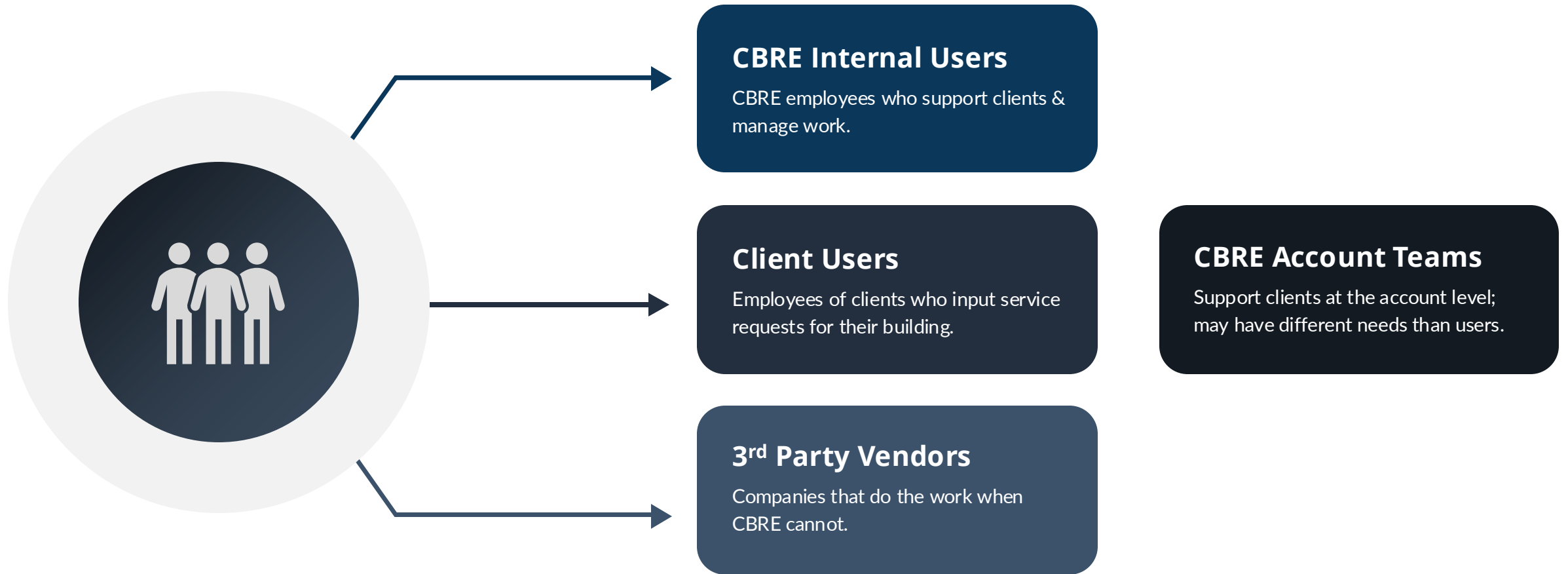


Lead UX Researcher

- Lead research for IFM Hub, including the Work Order domain.
- Manage consultant team for research activities on this project.

Relevant Customers

End Users & Key Stakeholders



Case Study #3

Project Considerations



Timeline

- 12-week contract with consultants
- Research completed as soon as possible



Scale

- 100+ accounts
- Around 5,000 Facility Managers and Facility Coordinators



UXR Scope

- Review of Past Research
- Semi-Structured Interviews



Team

- Lead UX Researcher
- Consultant Team
- Product Director

Research Questions

Determined at kickoff meeting & socialized in research plan

01



Review of Past Research

1. Where do CBRE employees spend most of their time when managing work orders?
2. What steps are duplicative or more manual than they could be?
3. What pain points arise because of these inefficiencies?



02

Semi-Structured Interviews

1. What steps in the work order management process do users spend the most time on?
2. How much time do they spend on those steps?
3. What information do users need to act and what actions do they take to progress a work order?

R&D Activities



The project team started work in April with a formal plan due by end of Q2.



Key Findings

Research identified tracking and updating the work order as the step in which there was the most opportunity for agentic assistance.

Key Pain Points

1. **Lack of awareness** of WO priority and action-triggering information.
2. **Lack of visibility** into workflow bottlenecks across the work order lifecycle.
3. Significant FM time is spent on **email coordination of WOs between multiple parties.**



Auditor Agent

Flags SLA risks & bottlenecks



Actor Agent

Resolves stuck tickets & corrects priorities



Notifier Agent

Sends targeted alerts



Quality Agent

Detects patterns & anomalies

Impact & Measurement

4 Agents & How Success Will Be Measured



Auditor Agent

Flags SLA risks & bottlenecks



Actor Agent

Resolves stuck tickets & corrects priorities



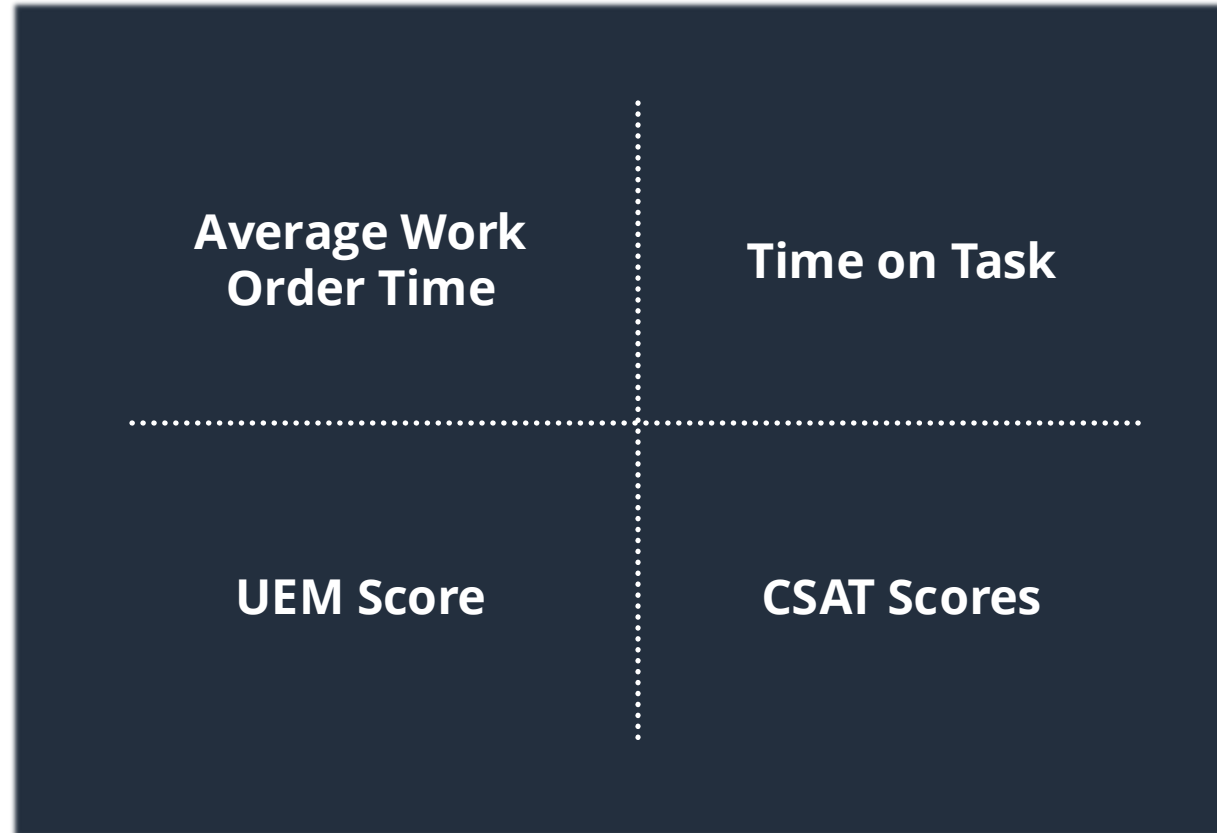
Notifier Agent

Sends targeted alerts



Quality Agent

Detects patterns & anomalies



Key Challenges



Lack of Product Analytics

Our product analytics capabilities matured throughout the year but were spotty before Q3 as events were being set up.



Initial Confusion on Research Lead

The consultant team was brought on to do everything, but I took lead on research as their planned research was a duplication of past internal research.



Questions?

